SentinelIQ 06 — Presentation & Interview Playbook

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This playbook turns SentinelIQ into a three-minute story, a README and a live demo that a hiring panel can follow and test.

The 3-minute story

1. **Problem (30 seconds):** analysts face thousands of alerts a day and most are noise, so real attacks wait in the queue.
2. **Solution (45 seconds):** SentinelIQ scores each event with ML, explains the risky ones by citing MITRE ATT&CK techniques, and keeps a human in the final decision.
3. **Proof (60 seconds):** show the evaluation metrics, then a live demo from alert to recorded decision.
4. **Depth (45 seconds):** name one design trade-off and one hard bug you fixed, and invite questions.

README structure

A recruiter often reads only the top of the README, so the order below matters.

1. One-line pitch and a link to the live demo.
2. A short demo GIF or video of the analyst workflow.
3. Architecture diagram with one sentence per component.
4. Metrics table: precision, recall, false-positive rate, explanation accuracy.
5. Quick start: the single command that runs everything.
6. Design decisions and trade-offs, linking to the ADRs.
7. Security notes, linking to the threat model.
8. Limitations and what you would build next.

Live demo script

The demo takes about six minutes and uses pre-loaded data, so nothing depends on live typing.

Step	Time	What to show	What to say
1	0:30	Log in as an analyst	Roles limit what each user can see and do
2	1:00	Send a batch of events through the API	Ingestion is validated and idempotent
3	1:00	Open the prioritized queue	Scoring ranks the queue so the riskiest events come first
4	1:30	Open a flagged event with its explanation	The explanation cites ATT&CK techniques that retrieval found
5	1:00	Dismiss one alert and escalate another, with notes	Every decision is written to an audit log
6	1:00	Show the metrics view and the evaluation table	These are the real numbers, including the weak spots

Interview questions to prepare

Write a 60-second answer for each, using real choices from your own build.

Likely question	Answer angle
Why this project?	The alert-fatigue problem, and how it joins backend, ML and security
Why retrieval instead of fine-tuning an LLM?	Cheaper, auditable, and every claim can cite its source
How do you know the model works?	Held-out test set, per-class metrics, and the weak spots you found
What if an attacker poisons the logs?	The prompt-injection controls and your adversarial test set
How would this scale 100 times?	Queue and workers, partitioned storage, caching, separate scoring service
What was your hardest bug?	One concrete story: symptom, investigation, root cause, fix, test added

Likely question	Answer angle
What would you change with more time?	A feedback loop for retraining and a streaming ingestion path

Honest-scope statements

Say these before the interviewer asks; they signal maturity rather than weakness.

- The authentication logs are synthetic, because real security data is not available outside a company.
- The network data is a public benchmark, and its results do not guarantee the same performance on live traffic.
- SentinelIQ assists analysts and does not replace them or act on its own.
- The performance numbers come from a laptop-class setup, and the document says how they were measured.
- Known weak spots, such as attack classes with low recall, are listed in the README together with ideas to fix them.

Target roles

The same project supports several job profiles; change which part you lead with.

Role	Lead with	Back it up with
Backend engineer	Ingestion design, idempotency, auth, tests, CI	API spec, load-test results
AI / ML engineer	Scoring pipeline, evaluation, RAG grounding	Metrics table, retrieval evaluation
Security engineer	Threat model, prompt-injection controls, audit log	Adversarial test results
Full-stack engineer	The analyst workflow end to end	Live demo and dashboard